



ELITE FEMALE TENNIS PLAYERS HAVE FOUND WAYS TO OPTIMISE THEIR STRENGTHS, MAKING THEIR GAME JUST AS COMPELLING AND PHYSICALLY DEMANDING AS MEN'S



Adapt

- **Technique and Strategy:**

Women's tennis emphasises angles, consistency, and court coverage rather than sheer power.

- **Training Adaptations:** Strength training, mobility work, and biomechanical refinements help female athletes maximise their potential.

- **Mental and Tactical Edge:** Women's tennis often features longer rallies and more strategic point construction, requiring high levels of mental toughness and endurance.

While these differences exist, elite female tennis players have found ways to optimise their strengths, making their game just as compelling and physically demanding as men's tennis. It's not about disadvantages — it's about playing to their strengths.

How much do training and environment matter?

Even with the best genetics, training, nutrition, recovery, and coaching are essential. Serena Williams (**facing page, below**), Rafael Nadal, and Novak Djokovic didn't just rely on their natural abilities — they optimised every aspect of their game through relentless work and smart preparation.

What is the remaining 45% that contributes to elite performance in tennis?

Technology, such as racquet design, weather conditions, court surface, travel schedule, and coaching quality, to name a few factors.



Need for speed: Due to differences in upper-body muscle mass and leverage, men generally hit harder serves and groundstrokes. One of the fastest recorded women's serves — Sabine Lisicki (in pic) at 131 mph — is still well below John Isner's record of 157mph.